```
ModelState.AddModelError(string.Empty,
    "The first letters of the name and code must match");
```

5.3.5 Custom validation attributes

There is one problem with writing validation code in a handler method: it is not reusable. You have established that the country name and code must start with the same letter, and you have ensured that when countries are created, that rule is enforced. However, you also need to enforce the rule when countries are updated for whatever reason. You could copy and paste the code from the Create page's `OnPost` handler, but then you introduce a maintenance problem. If changes are required to the validation logic, they have to be applied in multiple places. Instead, you can centralize the logic in a custom validation attribute, which you can reuse throughout the application.

Custom validation attributes derive from `ValidationAttribute`. The validation logic is placed within an overridden `IsValid` method that returns a `ValidationResult` object. An overload of the `IsValid` method provides us access to the `ValidationContext`, which holds information about aspects of the validation operation, including the rest of the model being validated. This is the version you need to use, so you can get a reference to other properties. Create a folder within the project named ValidationAttributes, and within that, add a C# class named `CompareFirstLetterAttribute` with the following code.

Listing 5.31 Custom validation attribute

```
public class CompareFirstLetterAttribute : ValidationAttribute        ❶
{
    public string OtherProperty { get; set; }                         ❷

    protected override ValidationResult IsValid(object value,
```